

THE HONEY DRESSING: METHOD, SCHEDULE, RED FLAGS

Four weapons in one jar. How to pick it, how to dress a wound with it, and when it is not enough.

THE FOUR WEAPONS

Drought

Honey sits near 0.6 water activity. Most bacteria need above about 0.9, and the toughest wound germs give up around 0.86.

Acid

Honey drops the wound surface into orange juice territory. Wound germs cannot multiply in acid.

Peroxide

Glucose oxidase makes it in tiny amounts, continuously, for hours. Kills bacteria, spares your tissue.

Rinse

Fluid drawn up from below lifts dead tissue and pus into the dressing, and keeps the pad from gluing to the scab.

WHICH JAR

- ☐ **First choice:** medical grade manuka gel or honey pads, about 20 to 40 dollars. Sterilized with gamma radiation, keeps for years. Put it in the kit now.
- ☐ **Backup, the 4 dollar jar:** raw, unpasteurized honey. Read the label.
- ☐ Skip pasteurized honey. Heat kills the enzyme, and you are down to two weapons.
- ☐ Skip anything labeled honey blend or honey syrup. It may be mostly corn syrup.
- ☐ Darker honey generally carries more antibacterial punch than pale.
- ☐ Store sealed, in the dark, away from the stove. Light and heat wear the enzyme down.
- ☐ Crystallized? Stand the jar in warm tap water. Never boil or microwave it.
- ☐ Keep one jar just for the kit. Never scoop with the finger you dressed the wound with.



Spread it on the pad, not into the wound.

THE DRESSING METHOD

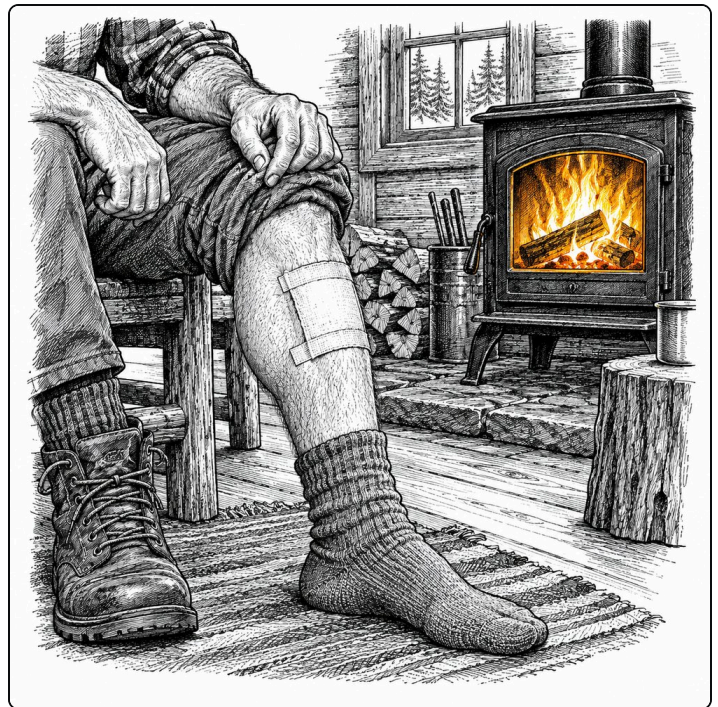
- 1** Rinse the wound with clean water, boiled and cooled if you are not sure of it.
- 2** Do not drizzle honey into the hole. Spread it thick on the dressing pad.
- 3** Press the pad honey side down. Cover the wound and about an inch of skin around it.
- 4** Cover with a dry absorbent layer and tape it.
- 5** **Change it once a day**, or sooner if the outer layer soaks through. A diluted, wet sugary pad is worse than none.

WHAT TO EXPECT

- ☐ More weeping than usual for the first few days. That is the rinse working.
- ☐ A sting for a minute on an open wound, from the acid.
- ☐ In the case reports: the smell goes, red edges fade and stop spreading, the base turns from yellow to a clean pink, and over weeks the wound closes from the bottom up.



Raw, unpasteurized, sealed, and kept just for the kit.



Dressed, covered, taped. Change it once a day.

RED FLAGS: HONEY IS NOT ENOUGH

- ☐ **A red streak running up the limb, a fever, or a wound going numb or black.** The infection has moved past the surface. That is blood poisoning, and it needs antibiotics inside the body. If a hospital exists, go.
- ☐ **Deep punctures.** Honey cannot touch the bottom.
- ☐ **Never give honey to babies under a year old.** Raw honey can carry dormant botulism spores.
- ☐ The raw jar is the backup for when care is gone, not a reason to skip care that is still open.
- ☐ A 2015 Cochrane review found honey healed partial thickness burns four to five days faster. For most other wounds it called the evidence too thin to rank honey above standard care.

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